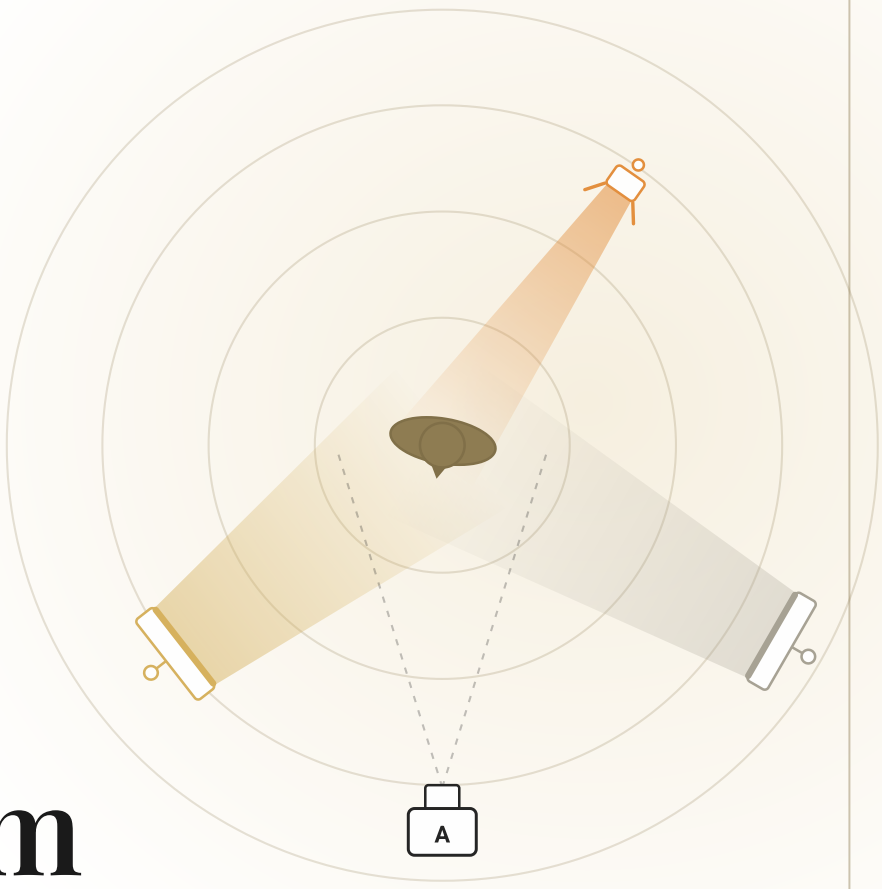


PRODUCER SPOTLIGHT

How to film the interview

A field guide for the crew: how to light the guest, which shots to take around the conversation and how to get the cover portrait. Two lighting setups inside, seated and standing.

01 **The interview** — p. 3–6
Three lights, seated or standing. 4K 16:9 for YouTube, cropped to 9:16 for Instagram.

02 **Additional shots** — p. 7
Arrival, greeting, the pour, the details, the outro: the shots that make the edit work.

03 **The portrait** — p. 8
One sharp, well-lit photo of the guest for the cover, like the Lynch-Bages reference.

BEFORE YOU START

Plan of the day

1. **Arrive 90 min early**
   Choose the spot: 2–3 m of depth behind the guest, no window in the shot, the quietest room you can get.
2. **Build light & cameras**
   Seated or standing setup (p. 5–6). Use a crew member as a stand-in while you light.
3. **Establishing & details**
   While the room is still free, film the estate, cellar, bottles and labels (p. 7).
4. **Guest arrives**
   If the greeting happens naturally, film it. If you miss it, re-stage it after the interview.
5. **Mic up & sound check**
   Lav mics on guest and interviewer. Listen in headphones before you roll.
6. **The interview**
   Both cameras rolling the whole time. Don't stop between questions.
7. **Portrait, straight after**
   Same light, guest still camera-ready. Take the mic off first (p. 8).
8. **Additional shots**
   Walk & talk, the pour, tasting, reactions, the outro (p. 7).
9. **Wrap**
   Back up every card to two drives before you leave. Write down the guest's name, title and the wines tasted.

KIT CHECKLIST

Light

- [ ] 2 × Raleno S192K panels, charged + chargers
- [ ] Zhiyun Fiveray M20C combo: barn doors, grid, diffuser
- [ ] USB-C power bank for the M20C
- [ ] 3 light stands (one tall, 2.2 m+) + sandbags
- [ ] Extension cord + power strip
- [ ] White reflector (optional fill)

Camera

- [ ] Camera A + Camera B (optional), 2 tripods
- [ ] Lenses: 24–70 mm, 50 mm, 85 mm
- [ ] Gimbal for walking shots
- [ ] Spare batteries, empty formatted cards
- [ ] Phone for vertical behind-the-scenes

Sound

- [ ] 2 lav mics (guest + interviewer) + receivers
- [ ] Headphones
- [ ] Backup recorder / second track
- [ ] Spare batteries

Small things

- [ ] Gaffer tape (cables + floor marks)
- [ ] Blotting paper / powder for shiny skin
- [ ] Lens cloth
- [ ] Printed question list
- [ ] Guest's name & title, spelled correctly

IF YOU REMEMBER ONLY THREE THINGS

1

Light the face, not the room

Key on the side the guest looks to. The background stays darker than the face.

2

Stay inside the 9:16 window

Every interview frame must also work as an Instagram Reel.

3

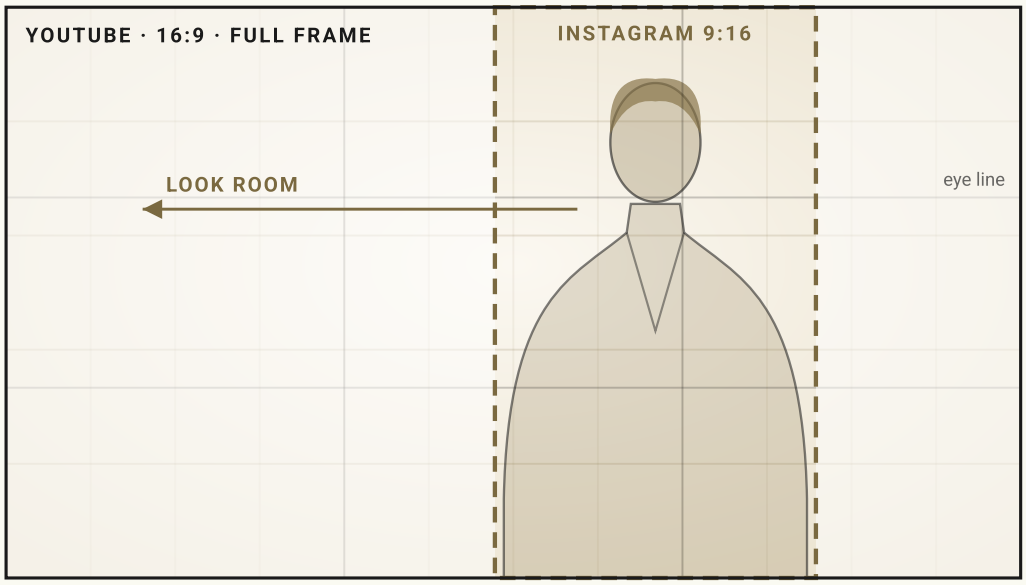
Back up before you leave

Two copies of every card, checked, before anything is formatted.

ONE SHOOT, TWO FORMATS

Frame for YouTube & Instagram

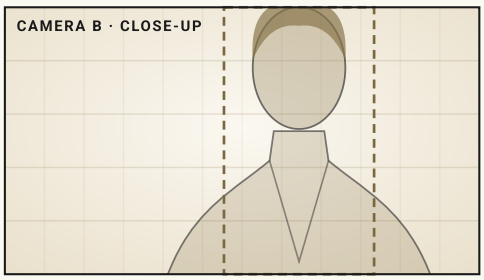
Shoot everything **horizontal, in 4K**. YouTube gets the full 16:9 frame; the editor cuts the vertical 9:16 version out of the same shot. That only works if the guest stays inside the vertical window.

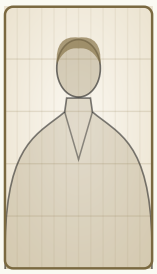


THE RULE
Camera A: head and shoulders always inside the gold 9:16 window (≈ ⅓ of the frame).

THE EDIT
YouTube uses the full frame; Instagram cuts the window out of the same shot.

NEVER
zoom during answers or let gestures and props leave the window.





Camera A: medium shot
Top of the head to the belt. Guest on the right third, looking left towards the interviewer.

Camera B: close-up
Top of the head to mid-chest, about 30° to the side of A, same side of the 180° line.

CAMERA SETTINGS

Resolution	4K UHD 3840 × 2160, 16:9
Frame rate	25 fps · 50 fps for slow-motion B-roll
Shutter	1/50 s (1/100 s at 50 fps)
Aperture	f/2.8–f/4: face sharp, background soft
ISO	as low as the light allows
White balance	manual, same Kelvin as the lights, same on A and B
Focus	face / eye AF, or manual. Re-check after every break
Picture profile	identical on both cameras

25 fps matches Europe's 50 Hz mains, so lamps in the background won't flicker.

SOUND

- Lav mic hidden under the shirt or jacket, 15–20 cm below the chin. No rustling fabric.
- Headphones on for the whole interview.
- Switch off wine fridges, air-con and ventilation during takes if you can. Phones in flight mode.
- Record 30 seconds of room silence at the end. The editor needs it.
- Two cameras: one clap in view of both at the start.

THREE LIGHTS, ONE LOOK

The light setup

Classic three-point light. The face is lit from the side the guest is looking towards. The background stays darker than the face, and a thin warm edge separates the guest from it.

Camera-left / camera-right = as seen standing behind the camera.

KEY LIGHT

Raleno S192K #1

The main light on the face. It decides the look.

Where	camera-left, ≈45° from the guest's nose, on the side the guest looks to
Distance	1–1.2 m. The panel is soft but not strong: keep it close
Height	above eye level, tilted down ≈30°
Power	start at 70–90 %

FILL LIGHT

Raleno S192K #2

Softens the shadows on the other side. It should not remove them.

Where	camera-right, ≈60°, or bounced off a white wall / reflector
Distance	1.5–2 m
Height	eye level
Power	20–35 %, about a third of the key

HIGHLIGHT / RIM

Zhiyun Fiveray M20C

A thin warm edge on hair and shoulders that lifts the guest off the dark background.

Where	behind the guest, camera-right (opposite the key)
Height	≈2 m, aimed down at the back of the head and the shoulder
Shape	barn doors + grid on, so it never shines into the lens
Power	30–50 %, colour 300–500 K warmer than the key

One colour temperature for everything

All lights on the **same Kelvin**. Set white balance on **both cameras** to the same number manually, never auto. Only the M20C rim goes slightly warmer.

5600 K
Daylight from a window reaches the set

3200–4300 K
Cellar or interior with warm lamps only

BUILD IT IN THIS ORDER

1. Put the guest's chair or tape mark 2–3 m in front of the background.
2. Set Camera A at eye level and the interviewer right beside the lens.
3. Switch off ceiling lights and close curtains on windows that hit the set.
4. Key on. Move it until the face looks shaped, with a soft shadow on the far cheek.
5. Fill on. Raise it until the shadow side looks soft but still darker.
6. Rim on. Move it until a thin glowing edge appears on hair and shoulder in the monitor.
7. Background: a lamp, candle or softly lit shelf. Always darker than the face.

CHECK ON THE MONITOR

- [ ] Catch-light (small reflection of the key) in both eyes
- [ ] No light, stand or cable in the frame
- [ ] No flare from the rim: close the barn doors
- [ ] Glasses: no reflection. Raise the key or move it wider
- [ ] Forehead and nose not shiny: blot or powder
- [ ] Skin looks natural on both cameras

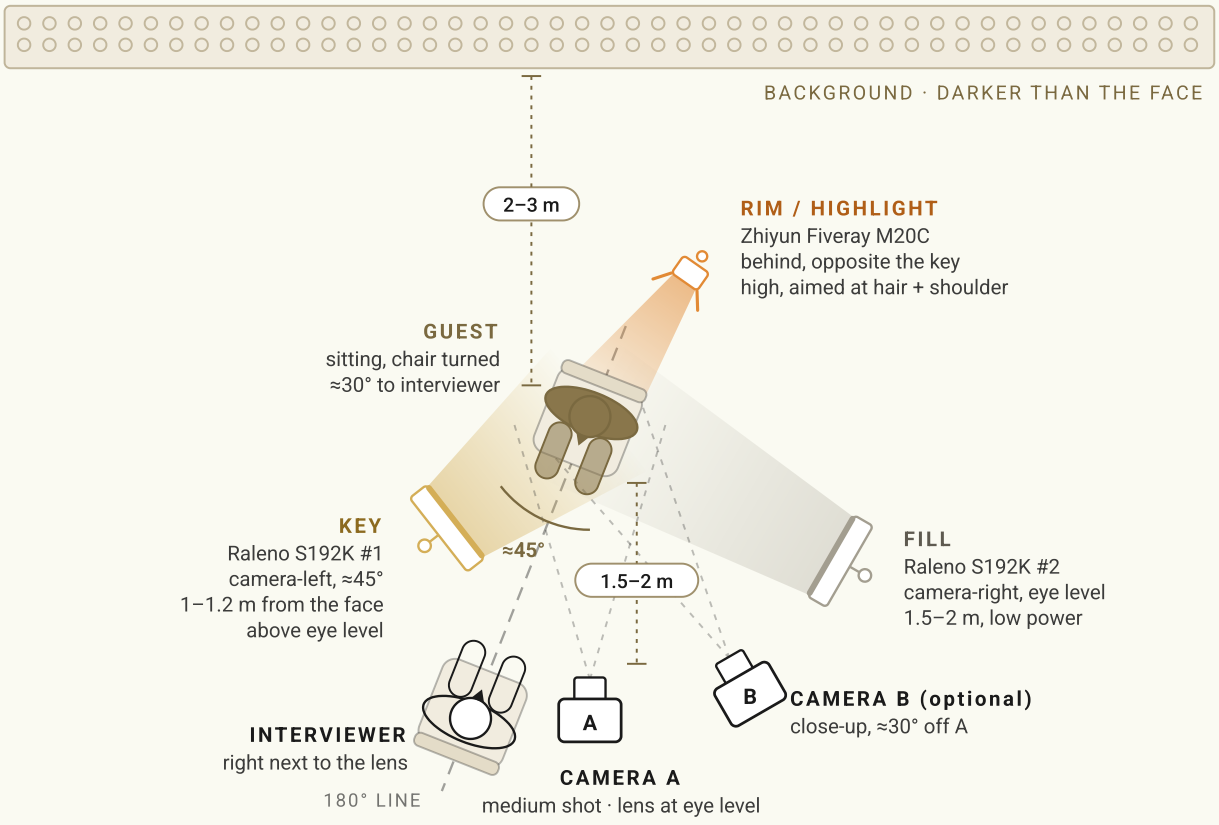
Batteries: the M20C runs about 40 min at full power, so keep it on a USB-C power bank. Charge both Raleno panels the night before and keep their chargers on set.

OPTION A

Seated interview

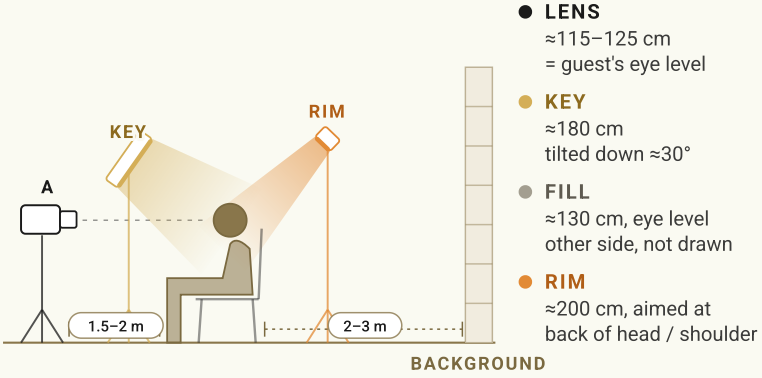
Best for long conversations (20 min and more). Calm and relaxed, the classic Producer Spotlight look.

TOP VIEW



Key · Raleno Fill · Raleno Rim · M20C Camera + field of view Guest Interviewer

SIDE VIEW: HEIGHTS



NOTES

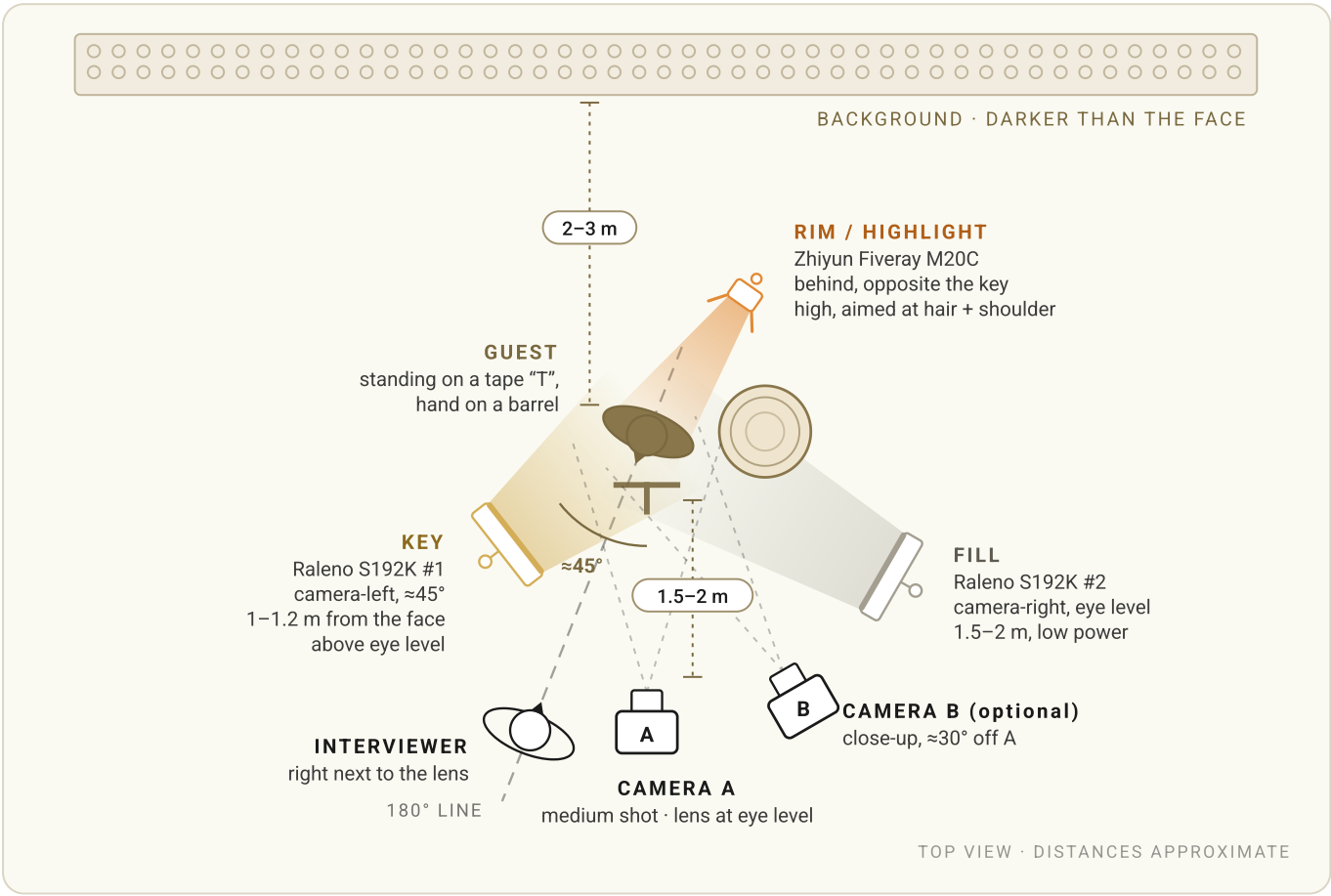
- Chairs without wheels, armrests or swivel. Guest sits on the front half of the seat, back straight.
- Guest's chair turned ≈30° towards the interviewer, so the body is not square to the lens.
- Interviewer sits right next to Camera A, eyes at lens height. The guest looks just past the lens.
- Never shoot down on the guest: lens at their eye level.
- Optional: a barrel or small table with a glass and the producer's bottle (label to camera), outside the 9:16 window.

OPTION B

Standing interview

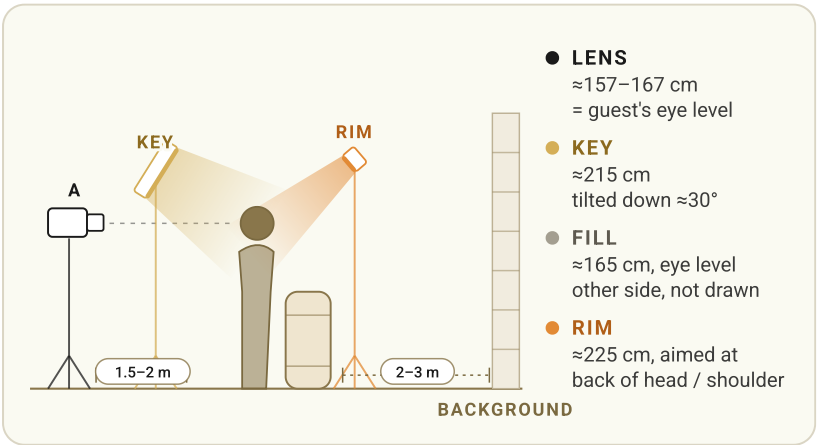
Good for short interviews or a cellar or tasting-room setting. More energy, more hand gestures.

TOP VIEW



Key · Raleno Fill · Raleno Rim · M20C Camera + field of view Guest Interviewer

SIDE VIEW: HEIGHTS



NOTES

- Tape a "T" on the floor where the guest stands. Standing people drift and sway.
- Something to lean on or rest a hand on: a barrel or a high tasting table.
- Feet slightly staggered, body ≈30° to the interviewer, who stands next to the lens.
- Stands fully extended (key ≈2.1 m, rim ≈2.2 m). Sandbag them.
- Camera A a little wider, from mid-thigh up: gestures matter more standing. Keep them inside the 9:16 window.

COVERAGE FOR THE EDIT

Additional shots

The edit needs pictures to cut away to and to tell the story around the conversation. Shoot them before and after the interview, in the same light where possible.

01



Establishing

The estate, entrance, vineyard, cellar. Slow pan or static, 10 s each.

WIDE

02



The arrival

Guest walks in through a door or along the cellar. Static wide, then follow from behind.

WIDE · MEDIUM

03



The greeting

Handshake or hello with the AVU host. A two-shot, then a close-up of the handshake.

MEDIUM · CLOSE

04



Walk & talk

Guest and host walk side by side through the barrel room. Camera walks backwards in front.

GIMBAL · MEDIUM

05



Open & pour

Cork out, wine into the glass, label turned to the camera.

CLOSE · 50 FPS

06



Swirl, nose, taste

Glass close-up, then the guest tasting in profile with the rim light behind the glass.

CLOSE · 50 FPS

07



Hands & details

Hands on a barrel, labels, vintages, corks, tools: everything the guest talks about.

CLOSE

08



Listening & reactions

Guest listening, smiling, nodding. Get the interviewer too. The edit needs these cutaways.

MEDIUM · CLOSE

09



The outro

Guest raises a glass to the camera (“Santé!”). The closing shot for the Reel.

MEDIUM

RULES FOR EVERY SHOT

- **Hold every shot 10 seconds.** No zooming while recording.
- **Every action in 3 sizes:** wide, then medium, then close.
- **Repeat each action 2–3 times.** The first take is usually stiff.
- **Move slowly**, on a gimbal or tripod. 50 fps for slow-motion moments.
- The guest **doesn't look into the camera** in B-roll, except in the outro.
- Horizontal 4K like the interview. Film behind-the-scenes vertical on a phone for Stories.

THE COVER PHOTO

The portrait

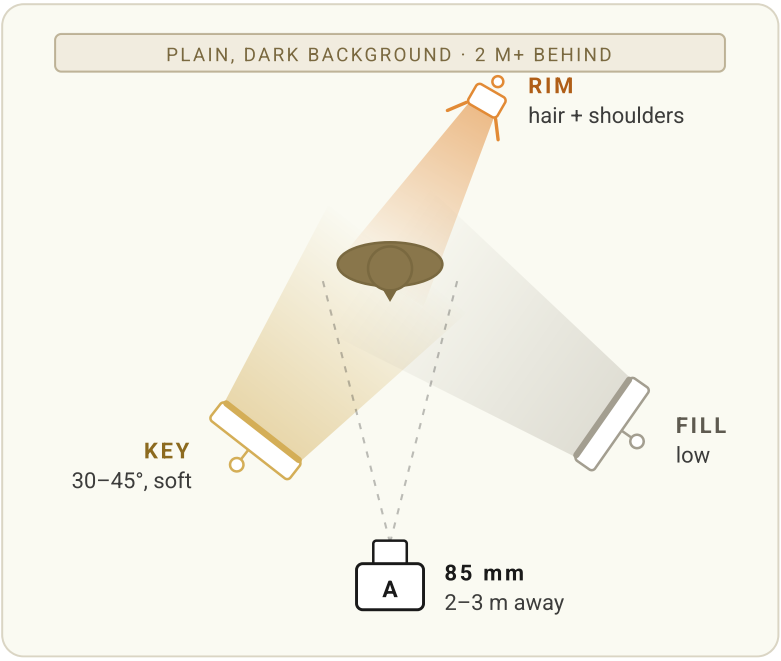
One high-quality photo of the guest for the cover. The guest is cut out and placed on a branded background, as in the reference, so the photo needs **clean edges, even light and room to crop**.



Reference: our cover with Jean-Charles Cazes, Château Lynch-Bages.

1. Eyes in the upper third, looking straight into the lens.
2. Rim light on hair and shoulders: a clean edge for the cut-out.
3. Arms crossed, relaxed, natural smile.
4. Shoot wider than this crop: never cut elbows or hands.
5. Space on one side for the title.

LIGHT



Keep the interview lights and turn the guest to face the lens. Key closer to the camera (30–45°) for a more even face. Plain, uncluttered background: no plants or bottles growing out of the head, no coloured walls.

CAMERA

Format	RAW + JPEG
Lens	85 mm (70–105 mm)
Aperture	f/4–f/5.6, whole face sharp
Shutter / ISO	1/200 s · ISO 100–400
Focus	eye AF on the nearest eye
Height	camera at eye level or slightly below

FRAME

- Vertical first, from the top of the head to mid-thigh.
- Also a few **horizontal** frames with space on one side for YouTube thumbnails.
- Leave space around the guest. The designer crops, we can't add.

POSES

- Arms crossed, like the reference.
- Hands in pockets · holding a glass.
- Holding their bottle, label to camera and no glare.
- Body turned 20–30°, face to the lens, chin slightly forward.

BEFORE YOU CLICK

- [ ] Mic and cable removed
- [ ] Collar, hair, jacket buttons, lint
- [ ] Phone and keys out of pockets
- [ ] Glasses: no reflections
- [ ] 50+ frames. Zoom to 100 % to check the eyes are sharp before the guest leaves